

Message ID	<1656268454.1656407.1768700618133@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Barry" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Sat, Jan 17, 2026 at 08:43 PM (Incoming)
Subject	AA County polling locations
Thread Subject	AA County polling locations
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

To: JARED DeMARINIS,
STATE ADMINISTRATOR OF ELECTIONS

Dear Mr. DeMarinis,

I understand that the State Board of Elections is meeting this coming week to discuss the placement of polling stations across Maryland including Anne Arundel county. The Anne Arundel County Board of Elections has provisionally approved the use of the Earleigh Heights Fire Station as a polling station. However, a candidate for office is currently a leader at Earleigh Heights. I feel this could create a potential conflict of interest which would be bad for the State of Maryland.

Therefore I am asking you not to approve the EHVFS and, instead, choose the Severna Park Public Library on McKinsey Road. The Library has been my polling place for many years and is convenient to a great number of citizens. It is also less expensive. And most important, it would not permit the suspicion of unfair influence in the election.

Given the extremes of partisanship at every level of government right now, and the escalation of political rhetoric, specifically calling into question the validity of our election system, the bedrock of our democracy, it is urgent that polling locations, as well as other features of the upcoming election, be without reproach or appearance of favoritism or undue advantage to either side.

Thank you for your dedicated work in support of American democracy.

Sincerely,
Barry Kessler

[REDACTED]

Barry Kessler

[REDACTED]

Message ID	<OF64A9DD-3D13-4A36-AA2F-C9B8B947A346@yahoo.com>
From	"Louise Raphael [REDACTED]"
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 12:19 PM(Incoming)
Subject	Neutral polling site
Thread Subject	Neutral polling site
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Dear Board Members,

This year a candidate who is part of the leadership team of the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Department is running for office. The Anne Arundel County Board of Elections has provisionally APPROVED the use of Earleigh Heights VFS as a polling station and, therefore, the State Board will be considering finalizing that location.

Is this not an appearance of a conflict of interest?

Please vote for a neutral polling site.

Thank you,
Louise Raphael

Message ID	<CAKAyqDSEmdK2JkVHkhH36D=dW5sZqJ=6SomM7iJa7JuRNafEtA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Suz Lev" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>,<elections@aacounty.org>,<eoatki22@aacounty.org>,<eoelli21@aacounty.org>,<eoewan23@aacounty.org>,<eorhei23@aacounty.org>,<eopral23@aacounty.org>
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 01:33 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Polling place conflict
Thread Subject	Polling place conflict
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Dear Mr. Demarinis, I am a resident of Severna Park and live not far from the Earleigh Heights fire station. Dave Crawford, the fire chief at EHVFD, has announced plans to run for County Executive. I am writing to urge you to no longer consider the Earleigh Heights fire station as a polling place for the upcoming elections as this is a direct conflict of interest. I also note it appears that the fire station is building a sign, potentially a campaign sign in front of the station- also a gross conflict of interest. Please consider alternate polling places such as the Severna Park Library. Regards, Suzanne Leveille Severna Park	

Message ID	<1510135466.1409365.1768764180883@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Marie McCarren" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	"elections@aacounty.org" <elections@aacounty.org [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 02:23 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Earleigh Heights
Thread Subject	Earleigh Heights
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Dear Sirs/Madams: I am a registered Republican, and my brother-in-law is a long-time volunteer firefighter, but even I don't like the idea of Earleigh Heights Fire Station being used as a polling place when one of the candidates is a firefighter there. Surely we can agree that just doesn't look good. Sincerely, Marie McCarren Arnold, MD	

Message ID	<62504AE9-7599-418C-B325-B43A22A449E5@gmail.com>
From	"Ericamcfarland [REDACTED]"
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>,<elections@aacounty.org [REDACTED]> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 03:03 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Polling location conflict
Thread Subject	Polling location conflict
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Good afternoon, I am writing to alert you to a possible conflict of interest in the upcoming elections. Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Department has been used as a polling place in the past, however, in this election, the Chief of EHVFD is a candidate. I believe that due to this, EHVFD should not be used as a polling location, but instead Severna Park library could be utilized. Please consider the possibility of the conflict of interest that would arise if a polling place is also a candidate's workplace. Thanks, Erica McFarland Unaffiliated voter [REDACTED] [REDACTED]	

Message ID	<CACHWDHE3L402LQ--4veuRX1La6t_RD-HBASbCi-3S8oKydU2hA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Debi Jasen" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	<elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 03:06 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Polling Station - Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station
Thread Subject	Polling Station - Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
To Whom It May Concern at the Maryland State Board of Elections; I am greatly concerned that the Earleigh Heights fire station is being considered as a possible polling station, considering that someone in a leadership position there is running for office. The Severna Park library does not employ anyone with a conflict of interest, and is a perfectly adequate voting location. It's also much easier to enforce electioneering rules and counter voter intimidation methods at Severna Park library than it is at the Earleigh Heights fire station. Please do not approve the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station as a polling location this year. Thank you for your consideration. Sincerely, Debi Jasen	

Message ID	<621030415.958669.1768767741646@mail.yahoo.com>
From	"Khristine Smith [REDACTED]"
To	NOADDRESS
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 03:22 PM (Incoming)
Subject	concerns about earleigh heights fire department continuing to be used as a polling station
Thread Subject	concerns about earleigh heights fire department continuing to be used as a polling station
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Good afternoon, I am writing to you to please consider taking the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire department off the list of potential polling places this coming November election. I am a voter and Anne Arundel county resident. I lived and voted in Severna park many many years. Polling locations should not have a sense of conflict of interest. polling places should be neutral and safe for everyone to feel comfortable voting. This November, a man named Dave Crawford is running for Anne Arundel County Executive, he is also on the leadership team and volunteer firefighter at the Earleigh Heights fire department. This should not be allowed. He will easily be able to persuade or make voters uncomfortable when they go in, he may even have his campaign signs up and visible closer to the voter booths then legally allowed. Severna Park library on McKinnsey Rd. is local and neutral. They have parking and additional parking right behind at the senior living place. I know you are meeting this week to consider polling locations, I urge you to keep this in mind when deciding for the county/state. Thank you very much, Khristine Smith Khristine Smith [REDACTED]	

Message ID	<CABzhFFSzpQcOvKZ6C0MsWUbnbTotHchYhOtV6VvaGrqZzXd3Tg@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Dawn Myers [REDACTED]"
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	<elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 04:52 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Earleigh Heights Fire Department Voting Location
Thread Subject	Earleigh Heights Fire Department Voting Location
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Dear Members of the Maryland State Board of Elections,

I am writing to respectfully object to the proposed relocation of on of the voting sites serving my district from the Severna Park Library on McKinsey Road to the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Department.

The Severna Park Library has long served as a familiar, centrally located, and accessible early voting site for voters in this area. Moving the location to the outskirts of the district creates an unnecessary barrier for voters, particularly those with limited transportation options, mobility concerns, or constrained work schedules. From a voter-access standpoint alone, the change is difficult to justify when a proven and well-known alternative is available. Additionally, I understand the cost of the move is significantly more. As we are substantially cutting County Government, this needs to be a concern as well.

More importantly, I am concerned about the appearance of a conflict of interest associated with using the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Department as a polling location in the current election cycle. The Fire Department has publicly endorsed candidates in the past, and at present, its chief is himself a candidate for public office. While I do not suggest any actual impropriety, the optics of situating a polling place at a facility so closely associated with an active candidate are troubling.

In an era when public confidence in elections is under strain, election administration must not only be fair but must be *clearly and unmistakably perceived* as fair. Avoiding even the appearance of partiality or undue influence is essential to maintaining trust in what has historically been a rock-solid electoral process in Maryland.

Given these concerns, I respectfully urge the State Board not to approve the use of the Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Department as a voting location and instead to retain or reinstate the Severna Park Library on McKinsey Road, which has successfully served voters in prior elections and does not raise similar concerns.

Thank you for your careful consideration of this matter and for your continued work to ensure accessible, impartial, and trustworthy elections.

Dawn Myers
[REDACTED]

Message ID	<CAFod5huG6ePYnWNZs7F=dU3QLYMrGzZHoSPxFMEW2wL8hTKQEA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Ruth Stemberger" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	<elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 05:32 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Earliegh Heights Fire Station and avoiding a conflict of interest
Thread Subject	Earliegh Heights Fire Station and avoiding a conflict of interest
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

Dear Board of Elections members,

With the potential conflict of interest between the EHVFS and the candidate running for election who is a leader at the EHVFS, I urge you to make the public library in Severna Park our polling place, and to **not approve the fire station as a polling place**. Thank you for showing your support for avoiding any possible conflict of interest in these times where **elections must be free and fair and polling places must be independent of any particular candidate**.

Kind regards,

Ruth Stemberger
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

Email is not a secure method of communication. Please be aware of this when determining the type of information you include in emails and/or that you request that I include in emails to you. If you request that I use email to communicate with you, I will consider that informed consent for me to use this method of communication and that you understand the security risks of doing so.

The email contains confidential information. This email is for the intended recipient only. If you receive this email in error, please reply to notify me that you were not the intended recipient and delete the email. Thank you.

Message ID	<9351CA51-D97F-4753-8A68-66F65185CA95@gmail.com>
From	"Dr. Benna Z Sherman" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	"elections@aacounty.org" <elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 07:47 PM (Incoming)
Subject	choice of polling place
Thread Subject	choice of polling place
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

In these challenging times we do not want there to be any semblance of conflict of interest or unfair influence over the elective process. The EHVFS would clearly be associated positively with one of the candidates. I'm asking you to choose Severna Park Public Library rather than the EHVFS as our polling station. Thank you for your consideration.

Benna Z Sherman, PhD
Licensed Psychologist
Severna Park MD 21146

[REDACTED]
General email:

[REDACTED]
Patient email:

Author of "How to Get and Give Love-- Relationship Maps"

Facebook:

CONFIDENTIALITY NOTICE: Please note that the confidentiality or security of email cannot be guaranteed. Please restrict email communication to administrative matters. Your continued use of email constitutes your acknowledgement of these confidentiality and security limitations. The most secure way of contacting me is by voicemail or via Secure Messaging in your Clier Portal at benna-sherman.clientsecure.me

"Three things in human life are important. The first is to be kind. The second is to be kind. The third is to kind." -- Henry James

Message ID	<CAAzn4Xu+qKqnYmns9N3BeETLh-0VOgtAL7VyGFPqG=Xd4Cp4tQ@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Fish Stark" [REDACTED]
To	<elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Sun, Jan 18, 2026 at 08:57 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Anne Arundel County Polling Locations
Thread Subject	Anne Arundel County Polling Locations
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Dear Maryland State Board of Elections, As a voter in Anne Arundel County and the Vice Chair of the Annapolis Democratic Party, I write to urge you to reject Earleigh Heights Volunteer Fire Station as a polling location and replace it with Severna Park Public Library. A candidate for office in Anne Arundel County is the Chief of the Earleigh Heights Fire Department and is promoting this on his literature. To be clear, this is not a concern; he has every right to highlight this experience to voters. However, it means the Earleigh Heights Fire Department is no longer a politically neutral location in this particular election and therefore is an inappropriate place for a polling station. Best, Fish Stark	

Message ID	<CADgsYje68oeTWu9uuMjFg1KhFw0Yt7U=LqqdZ6NOA59VkFy8sQ@mail.gmail.com>
From	"Nancy P Anselm [REDACTED]"
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Cc	<elections@aacounty.org> [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Mon, Jan 19, 2026 at 10:35 AM(Incoming)
Subject	Polling Place Severna Park Public Library
Thread Subject	Polling Place Severna Park Public Library
Return-Path	[REDACTED]

To: JARED DeMARINIS,
STATE ADMINISTRATOR OF ELECTIONS

Dear Mr. DeMarinis,

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Therefore I am asking you not to approve the EHVFS and, instead, choose the **Severna Park Public Library** on McKinsey Road. The Library has been my polling place for many years and is convenient to a great number of citizens. It is also less expensive. And most importantly, it would not permit the suspicion of unfair influence in the election.

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Thank you for your dedicated work in support of American democracy.

Sincerely,
Nancy Anselm

[REDACTED]

Message ID	<633D1296-810E-4FB3-A54B-8DD2ED83CBEA@kzmarketing.com>
From	"KZ Marketing" [REDACTED]
To	"info.sbe@maryland.gov" <info.sbe@maryland.gov>
Date	Mon, Jan 19, 2026 at 01:22 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Please use the SP Library rather than EHVFS for polling
Thread Subject	Please use the SP Library rather than EHVFS for polling
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
Hello - While I applaud the diversity of candidates and am also an enthusiastic supporter of Earleigh Heights, it seems there is a conflict of interest to use Earleigh Heights Fire Station as a polling station when one of the candidates is on the Board, as it would for any candidate who has influence at the facility. Please use SP Library as the polling location, rather than Earleigh Heights Fire Station to avoid the potential conflict or even appearance of conflict. This will help ensure elections are free and fair, without influence. Thank you. Karen Zaniker, SP resident Sent from my iPhone Karen Zaniker [REDACTED]	

Message ID	<CAAr0GTNkCRy7O6mwX0xibEQNawwntmYehNWAe-dUBHE9WoQBtA@mail.gmail.com>
From	"MF" [REDACTED]
To	<info.sbe@maryland.gov> [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]
Date	Mon, Jan 19, 2026 at 02:54 PM (Incoming)
Subject	Earleigh Heights Fire Station polling concern
Thread Subject	Earleigh Heights Fire Station polling concern
Return-Path	[REDACTED]
To Whom it May Concern I am a registered voter, and am concerned with Earleigh Heights Fire Station being used as a polling place when one of the candidates is a firefighter there. This could lead to awkward interactions and possible suspicions about the election there. Could you use the Severna Park Library, which has been used in previous years as a polling location? Sincerely, M Kelly Arnold, MD	